Welcome to the LVNA

Villager

The Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

May 2010 Volume 53, Number 5 Sunnyvale, California Editor Phyllis Fowler

May Monthly Meeting canceled this month

because of electricity problem at Park building

President's Column -Fred Fowler

Neighborhood News

Hello my friends. April was a good month for the neighborhood and the LVNA, and May looks like it will bring another set of challenges and opportunities. Things are starting to "cook" and the pace of activity is starting to build. Lakewood Village has always had the reputation of being a part of Sunnyvale where things happen. We're active in our neighborhood, and we're not afraid to roll up our sleeves and get our hands dirty working for a good cause.

Many other parts of the city watch what we do and marvel at the things we can accomplish. If our newsletter was a "real" newspaper, we'd have the third largest circulation of any news publication in the city! We routinely stage large events requiring dozens of volunteers. When it comes time to get certificates of recognition for our volunteers each year, the list of names easily surpasses 100 people. No place else in Sunnyvale has so much "community spirit".

LAKEWOOD PARK ELECTRICITY

As many of us have noticed, the electricity in Lakewood Park has been turned off since the beginning of April. The tentative date when it will be restored is "mid May". This outage has had a significant impact on the people and groups who use Lakewood Park during the evening. The Lakewood Pony League baseball group has been forced to bring in generators to power the snack bar during games. There are porta-potties outside of the public bathrooms in the park because there are no working lights inside the normal facilities. Most significantly (for us), the April LVNA meeting was held in the dark because we were not aware of the outage until we came to set things up.



The problem is an underground cable that runs through the park. There are many lights in the park that use a

(cont. on Page 2)

April Meeting a Night to Remember

By Fred Fowler

For those of you who missed our April general meeting, it was definitely one for the history books! Two representatives from Pacific Gas and Electric came to the Lakewood Park building to give a presentation on the "Smart Meters" that are being installed in our neighborhood. More than 50 people from Lakewood packed the meeting to hear the details and ask some pointed questions. Everyone agreed that the presentation gave quite a bit of valuable information and that their time at the meeting was well spent.

There was just one peculiarity about the event. It was held in the **dark!**

Two weeks prior to the meeting, the City of Sunnyvale began repairs on an underground electrical cable that supplies power to the park building and the park's pathway lights. When we showed up on the night of April 12th there was no electricity flowing anywhere near the park building. One of our neighbors pulled his car up to the doorway and volunteered the use of his power inverter, but there just wasn't enough juice to power the PG&E representatives' equipment. The representatives made their presentation the best they could. However, they just happened to have a number of tiny LED based flashlights to give away, (which proved to be very popular). In the end, the audience thanked the PG&E people for the information they had given, for their patience and for being such good sports about the situation. It was unanimously decided to invite PG&E back during our June meeting to give us the full presentation they had put together.

As for the LVNA's May general meeting, the situation doesn't look good. The power is still out as of the date I am writing this, and I've been told by the City of Sunnyvale that the power "might" be back on in time. There are no guarantees, however. Because of the uncertainty about power, we've decided to cancel the LVNA's May general meeting on the 12th. Please stay tuned, we'll be back in business in June! I look forward to seeing you then. ◆

of these questions, including the

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***Neighborhood News** cont.*

significant amount of "juice" when they are turned on. Not the least are the "stadium" lights that illuminate the baseball field at night, giving everyone from the Pony League to several adult softball leagues the chance to play after normal business hours. It has been a long time since all of those lights were installed, and I know that the underground cables have not been worked on for at least 15 years. Apparently one of them has developed a problem, and repairs are needed before it can handle the load at the park again.

Having a park without lights is more than just an inconvenience. It's a safety problem. People who are up to no good like to find dark places where they can meet and operate unobserved. Lakewood Park has lots of benches and tables where the wrong sort of meetings can take place and the wrong sort of activities can transpire, if there are no lights to drive the shadows away.

Until the power has been restored to Lakewood Park, I would like to ask everyone to be careful there after hours. If you notice anything unusual going on in the dark, please don't be shy about calling 911. Remember, our own kids may be the ones we'll be protecting. Let's keep an eye open for potential trouble.

And let's hope the City gets the underground cable fixed as soon as possible.◆

Looking for a Tribune of Trash or a Duchess of Debris.

By Fred Fowler

Greetings neighbors! The weather is finally getting nicer, and we all know what happens when the weather gets warm. *Dumpster Day* happens! Our nice climate and the City of Sunnyvale's contract with the Specialty Waste company gives us a chance to spend a day cleaning out our closets, spare rooms and back yards and getting rid of all the trash and junk that has accumulated there over the years. *Dumpster day* is a magic day for the neighborhood. There is a universal sense of "out with the old, in with the new" as we get rid of vestiges of the past. It is a time to let go of old things and to de-clutter our lives. It is also a time when neighbors get out of their houses and work together to spruce things up. It is not too much of an exaggeration to say that Dumpster Day is one of the reasons that Lakewood Village is one of the nicest places to live in Sunnyvale.

Like all good traditions, Dumpster Day takes a lot of work to stage each year. It is one of the largest all-volunteer activities in the City, and the amount of organization and coordination required is quite significant. On the Friday before the day "officially" begins, about 20 dumpsters get delivered to various parts of the neighborhood. The LVNA is under strict instructions to make sure the **dumpsters do not get loaded with hazardous waste** such as TV sets, wet paint, cleaners, and appliances containing Freon. That means that the dumpsters need to be watched. We'll need between 20 and 40 volunteers to monitor the dumpsters just to make sure they stay "clean" until the last one is taken away (*continued on page 3)*

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***Dumpster Day** cont..*

Finally, someone needs to be a liaison between the neighborhood, the City, and the Specialty Waste company to handle the planning of the event and also any unexpected situations that come up.



Luckily, our neighborhood has had a lot of practice putting on Dumpster Day. Many of the volunteers are "battle scarred veterans" who have been watching dumpsters for many years. My wife and I have been watching the dumpster outside of our home ever since 1996, and this year will mark our 14th consecutive year of doing so. Others have been watching dumpsters even longer. Many of us routinely answer questions by the City staff who have less experience with Dumpster Day than we do. By and large, we know the drill.

Even if all of the "worker bees" know their jobs, we still need someone to keep an eye on the "big picture" to make sure all of the i's are dotted and the t's are crossed. Someone needs to get out the lists of volunteers from last year and check to see if they are available (and willing) to repeat the job this year. Someone needs to work with the City to find out if there are any new rules or restrictions governing what can go into the dumpsters and what must be kept out. Someone needs to go over the places that the City wants to put the dumpsters and make sure they make sense from the point of view of the neighborhood. Someone needs to keep track of who actually participates during Dumpster Day, so that the LVNA can thank them appropriately afterward.

The amount of time needed to do these things is not really very much (the planning can probably be accomplished in a few evenings or a weekend). Also, there are plenty of experienced Dumpster Day coordinators (such as myself) who can give step-by-step guidance towards a successful conclusion.

So, I'm making a call for any potential "Dumpster Divas" or "Dukes of Detritus" who want to take a crack at organizing the event this year. If you ever wanted to try your hand at organizing a big, complicated production, this is the opportunity you have been waiting for. You'll have *(cont.)*

***Dumpster Day** cont.*

plenty of help from experienced people. With a little work and a little effort you'll make the day another great success for the neighborhood.

We have a great deal of talent in our little corner of Sunnyvale. Every time I've asked for help for the LVNA, someone has come forward to answer that call. How about YOU? Why don't YOU step forward, get involved and do an important task for the sake of your neighbors? I'll have to warn you, though. Most likely you'll have a lot of FUN doing it. Most of us "battle scarred veterans" of Dumpster Day take part because we LOVE it. It is hard, hot, messy work, but we look forward to it each year, nevertheless. It is hard to explain why. If you don't understand why we love it, then you have never taken part.

Dumpster Day 2010 is scheduled for July 17th. That means we'll have to start cranking things up for it in June. If you are interested in being the coordinator (and I know that someone out there is interested), then please e-mail me at fred@fmfa.com. If you prefer, please call me on my cell phone (408) 505-2813.

By the way, you don't need to be an "adult" to do this job. Juniors and seniors in high school, college kids, retried grandmothers and grandfathers, and everyone else in between are "eligible". With all of the experienced workers we have, we won't let you fail. Pick up the phone or the keyboard and let me know. You'll be glad you did.◆

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Fairwood School is having Rummage Sale! May 15th From 8am to 2pm

One person's junk can be someone else's treasure. Who knows what treasures you might uncover! You just might find the very item you have been searching for years!

Come one, come all to a spectacular rummage sale at Fairwood School. Support our Fairwood kids and have fun doing it! Come early and buy, buy, buy!!! ◆

"To the praise of the glory of His grace . . ."

Providence Bible Church of Sunnyvale
709 Lakewood Drive, Sunnyvale, CA 94089
408-734-2297 **http://www.lvbc-ca.org**

Sunday Services
9:30 a.m. Sunday School for all ages
11:00 a.m. Worship Service

Wednesday
7:00 p.m. Corporate Prayer Meeting

Health & Safety Fair

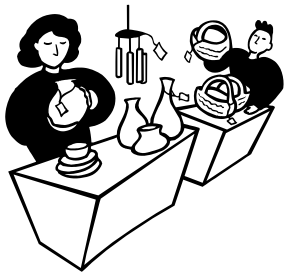
Saturday, May 22, 2010 from 11:00 am - 3:00 pm
Columbia Neighborhood Center
785 Morse Avenue, Sunnyvale

Celebrate National Bike Month and Ride Your Bike to the Fair!



The mission of the Health & Safety Fair is to provide health and safety information, health screenings and safety demonstrations to the Sunnyvale community with most services free of charge or at a low-cost. Each year only gets better with an array of local vendors and partners and this year's fair will include FREE: health screenings, bike safety inspections, nutrition information, entertainment, fun and music for the whole family!
Don't miss it! ◆

36th Sunnyvale Art & Wine Festival - June 5 & 6



Kick-off your Summer at the largest art & wine festivals in Silicon Valley. Each year more than 125,000 people crowd our downtown and our newly-renovated Murphy Avenue to experience more than 300 of the region's finest artisans, craftspeople, entertainment, a wide variety of food, as well as 24 local wine and microbrews. This year we are kicking it up a notch with Margaritas! We are going more "green" this year by offering compostable beer and wine cups and Commererative glasses will be available for purchase.

The Children's Area sponsored by Provident Credit Union cannot be missed! Kids rides and extra large jumpy houses and free hands-on activities provided by NASA, local businesses and non-profit organizations. Go to **www.svcoc.org** to download a coupon for **6 free** tickets with purchase of Jr. Family Pack 24 tickets fro $20. Tickets on sale at the Festival. ◆

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Financial Literacy for Youth

Thursday, June 3, 4:00 p.m.-5:30 p.m.
NOVA, 505 W. Olive, Ste. 550

Are you concerned that your son or daughter doesn't listen to you about money? Are you worried that they may not understand how to handle their money when they are on their own? Here's a workshop that can help! Financial expert Becky Jensen of the Financial Literacy Project will talk with youth about how to identify and work towards accomplishing their financial goals, stay out of debt, budgeting, banking basics, and managing living expenses. This workshop is for ages 13-21, but parents are welcome.

To register, call Columbia Neighborhood Center at (408) 523-8150 or send an e-mail to ChildCareResources@ci.sunnyvale.ca.us

Sibling Rivalry

Wednesday, May 12, 6:30 p.m. - 8:00 p.m.
Sunnyvale Public Library, 665 W. Olive Ave.



This workshop will address the issues and challenges that surround sibling rivalry as well as offer tips for coping with and handling sibling tension in the home. Learn steps to address and resolve sibling conflicts and how to foster strong and positive sibling relationships . Alicia Becerra Mendoza, Licensed Clinical Social Worker will facilitate this workshop. ◆

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Speeding Cars, parking complaints, traffic signal repair, dead animals	Dispatch 730-7180
Complaints, about noise or commercial vehicles on residential streets	Desk Officer 730-7110
Complaints about illegal storage, decrepit fences, buildings, weed problems, illegal home business-es, or rental housing	Neighborhood Preservation 730-7610
Animal Control	730-7178
City Streets, sidewalks, trees, streetlights,	Public Works 730-7505
Nuisance Vehicle Hotline	730-7706
Drug Hotline	245-3784
Graffiti Hotline	730-7680
Shopping Cart Pickup	725-1010

LVNA Contacts:

President Fred Fowler (408) 747-1454

Advertising Terry Lin (4080 747-1638

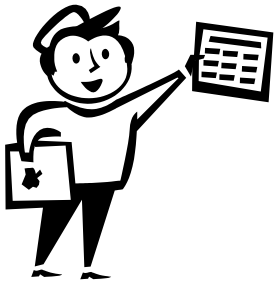
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Lakewood Wendy Stanley (4080 745-1331

LVNA *Villager*

Editorial Deadline for next month: by May 28th



WALKERS NEEDED!

Can you use a little exercise? Than how about volunteering to deliver the LVNA newsletter!

Wendy is looking to fill two routes:

Meadowlake to Lawrence Expressway

Hiddenlake and Greenlake

(can be split into 2 route)

If you are interested please call Wendy Stanley at (408) 745-1331

Upcoming Events

What	Where	When
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To contact the editor, Please call Phyllis Fowler at (408)747-1454 or email editor@lvna.net

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